course. The most common electives are business or family and consumer science classes. In the end, only about 16 percent of students have had an entire course in money management or personal finance while in high school, according to a 2006 survey by the Jump$tart Coalition for Personal Financial Literacy.

In an effort to increase the number of students graduating with adequate money management skills, many states have introduced legislation in recent years to include personal finance instruction in classes that are required and not just optional. However, as of 2007, only fifteen states have personal finance as part of a class that students must take prior to graduation.

This lack of instruction in personal finance occurs in spite of the fact that most young adults are willing to learn. Several surveys have confirmed this point in addition to pointing out the low level of financial literacy:

- A 2005 survey by Visa of high school students' parents discovered that 76 percent believed that schools should be required to teach money management skills.
- The Hartford study found that less than one-quarter of students said that they felt very well prepared to deal with the financial challenges that awaited them after college graduation.
- A 2006 Key Bank poll found that nearly one-third of college students, when thinking about their freshman year, admitted that they were "not at all" or "not very well prepared" for managing their money on campus.
- A 2006 survey by the Jump$tart Coalition for Personal Financial Literacy showed the average score to be an F on a test of personal finance basics administered to high school seniors.